

THE STADIUM

The armored race is underway. The banks of the stadium are crammed with spectators who shout in excitement and cheer on the runners. Athletes crash into each other as they circle the turning post on their way to their second length. From the judges' stand, the *Hellandodikai* watch carefully, looking out for any athletes who are tempted to cheat.



Olympic events

Athletics was a key part of the Olympic Games. Events included javelin, long jump, discus, and running races. There were many different races. As shown on this vase, the foot race was run by athletes who were completely naked, not wearing or carrying anything that could slow them down.

This vase shows three runners in close competition..



Race in armor

Athletes ran the armored race wearing heavy helmets, like the one shown here, and carrying shields. The race was a sprint up and down the length of the stadium's field, with a 180° turn around a post after the first length. Both speed and strength were required to succeed.



All for a wreath

This image shows a victor at the Olympics being crowned with the ultimate prize: a wreath from the sacred olive tree. Athletes also won fame, and some were rewarded with money.

